



BIRLA INSTITUTE OF TECHNOLOGY AND SCIENCE, Pilani
Pilani Campus
AUGS/ AGSR Division

FIRST SEMESTER 2026-27
COURSE HANDOUT

Date: 28.07.2026

In addition to part I (General Handout for all courses appended to the Time table) this portion gives further specific details regarding the course.

Course No : GS F 212
Course Title : Environment, Development and Climate Change (EDCC)
Instructor-in-Charge : Prof. Sailaja Nandigama
Instructor(s) : Archana Singh (TA)
Tutorial/Practical Instructors: NA

1. Course Description: This course focuses on the concepts of environment, development, and climate change in the contemporary world. The nature and causes of environmental problems in developing and developed countries will be explored. Attention is given to both the causes and solutions of environmental problems and the role of state and non-state actors interacting at local, national and global scales. The goal of this course is for the learners to appreciate the people-environment relations and to understand the anthropocentric dynamics of development and climate change.

2. Scope and Objective of the Course: The objective of the course is to make the students aware of the debates and issues relating to sustainable development and climate change, so as to sufficiently challenge them to come up with practical solutions. The course covers theory and practice at the global and local levels and examines the contemporary policy and practice regarding environment, development and climate change.

3. Text Books: Hempel, C. Lamont (1998), Environmental Governance: The Global Challenge, Affiliated East West Press Pvt Ltd, New Delhi. (Reading material will be given in pdf format).

4. Reference Books: Humphrey R. Craig, Tammy L. Lewis and Frederick H. Buttel (2002), Environment, Energy, and Society. Wadsworth Group, USA.

5. Course Plan:

Module No.	Lecture Session	Reference	Learning outcomes
1	TB: Chapter 1 Between Two Centuries & other introductory information (11 lecture sessions)	TB (pp. 1-28)	Students will be exposed to various concepts related to environment, development and climate change- and their background
2	TB: Chapter 2 Earth Summit or Abyss (10 lecture sessions)	TB (pp. 29-48)	Students will be able to appreciate the role of various demographic, Sociological and political factors influencing the environment
3	TB: Chapter 3 Causes of Environmental Destruction (10 lecture sessions)	TB (pp. 51-86)	Students will learn to identify and critically assess institutional and socio-political causes for environmental destruction, and map out strategies for managing environment and natural resources



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4	TB: Parts of Chapter 4 Global Warming: The Changing Climate in Science and Politics (10 lecture sessions)	TB (pp. 90- 116)	Students will be able to differentiate between optimal and dangerous levels of Climate Change and its relationship with Development
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6. Evaluation Scheme:

Component	Duration	Weightage (%)	Date & Time	Nature of component (Close Book/ Open Book)
Mid-Semester Test	90 Min.	30%	<10/10 FN1>	Close Book
Comprehensive Examination	3 h	40%	<15/12 FN >	Close Book/Open Book
*Class participation and attendance	70% classes	10%	NA	NA
Internal tests	40 minutes each	20%	Pre-announced	Close Book/Open Book

* This is applicable for students admitted after AY 2024-25.

7. Chamber Consultation Hour: Monday 11 am. to 12 noon. In 6168M (Class T Th F 11 am. to 11.50 am. in classroom 6154)

8. Notices: Shared on Classroom portal and through ERP.

9. Make-up Policy: Only genuine cases will get make-up opportunities in Mid-Sem and Comprehensive examinations, as determined by the IC. (Tests 1 and 2 will be announced in the class in advance and so, will not have make-up opportunities).

10. Attendance Policy: 70% attendance and above will be rewarded with 10% marks.

11. Minimum passing Marks criteria: 30% of the total marks must be obtained by each student to clear the course.

12. Note (if any): Course format will be interactive with regular class discussions and group exercises, documentary screening and presentations. Students are encouraged to attend classes and prepare in advance with the help of the reading material provided and through self-initiative as well.

Prof. Sailaja Nandigama
Instructor-in-charge
Course No. GS F 212